

Ageing in Style

FROM CHEF-LED DINING TO MEDICAL CARE AND RESORT-STYLE AMENITIES, PREMIUM SENIOR HOMES ARE REDEFINING LIFE AFTER 60

BY SMITA TRIPATHI

WHEN BIJIT AND Rashmi Sehgal sold their export business in Noida after the pandemic and moved to Bijit's hometown of Kasauli, they did not want an old-age home, or even a conventional retirement apartment. They wanted fewer chores, better views, and someone else worrying about dinner.

"We figured there would be others like us. So, we built Better Life Homes—a boutique senior-living property of 16 apartments," says Bijit, who is in his mid-60s.

Better Life Homes overlooks the hills, and its one- and two-bedroom residences are furnished, its kitchens are staffed by four chefs, and its days can include yoga, meditation, billiards, organised walks, barbecues and musical evenings. A spa and salon sit alongside medical support and health checks.

"We are a home for active senior citizens who are still living it up," says Bijit. "So, we organise



BETTER LIFE HOMES, KASALI is a boutique senior-living property of 16 apartments

barbecues and musical evenings, but of course having access to great medical facilities is also important," adds Rashmi. The property is close to a multi-speciality hospital.

Designed by Swiss architects and managed with hospitality services from Sodexo, the project is less an old-age home than a

private club with nurses nearby. That balance between indulgence and reassurance is defining India's fast-evolving senior-living industry. Once associated with institutional homes, the category is being repositioned as a premium lifestyle choice for older adults who are wealthier, healthier, and unwilling to com-